

Pakistan's Posers

30 queries on 26/11 and India's likely response



Q1 What has Ajmal Kasab said in his confession before the court?

Response: Yet to give a statement

Q2 Give his recent clear photographs

Response: Will send

Q3 Give his DNA samples and forensic analysis report

Response: They are a court property

Q4 Report of marks on his clothes

Response: Court has to authorise

Q5 Details of his national identity card

Response: Not recovered

Q6 Record of the items recovered from the culprits

Response: List already provided

Q7 Log details of GPS

Response: Shared with Pakistan

Q8 Details of call logs and forensic analysis of Thuraya satellite phone?

Response: Already given

Q9 Details of forensic analysis of the cell phones used by the attackers

Response: Court has to authorise it

Q10 DNA samples from the boats

Response: Court has to authorise it

Q11 The complete tapes of the intercepted conversation

Response: Selected tapes may be given

Q12 Seizure memo of items recovered

Response: Court has to authorise it

Q13 Complete tapes of intercepted conversation with the handlers

Response: Only relevant excerpts may be shared

Q14 Forensic analysis of SIM cards

Response: Court has to authorise it

Q15 Interrogation report of Tausif Rehman and Mukhtar Ahmed Sheikh arrested for providing SIM cards

Response: Details may be shared

Q16 How they got Indian SIM cards

Response: Smuggled to Pakistan

Q17 Details about the markings on the recovered weapons

Response: More details may be given

Q18 Photos of weapons seized

Response: Already provided

Q19 Clear photo of attackers

Response: Already provided

Q20 Complete details of all the culprits and their identity proofs

Response: No such documents found

Q21 Details of events leading to Karkare's death

Response: In public domain

Q22 Eyewitnesses' statements on Karkare's death

Response: Court has to authorise it

Q23 How the attackers reached Mumbai without refuelling?

Response: Boats had 2,200 litre of fuel

Q24 Did boats refuel in India?

Response: No

Q25 Why were the culprits not intercepted by the Indian Navy?

Response: Culprits hijacked Indian boat to avoid detection

Q26 Fingerprint samples of attackers with forensic analysis

Response: Court has to authorise it

Q27 How did Kasab recognise Zakir-ur Rehman Lakhvi?

Response: Met him during training

Q28 Source of Lakhvi's photo

Response: Can't be revealed

Q29 How did attackers reach Mumbai with arms and ammunition?

Response: Carried from Karachi

Q30 Details and forensic report of the digital diary recovered

Response: Court has to authorise it

prime minister Benazir Bhutto, how do you think they will hold a fair trial into the Mumbai attacks? These questions have been sent as part of a tactical shift by them, and I don't think anything will come out of it," says Ajit Doval, former director of the Intelligence Bureau. Another glaring omission in Pakistan's response is that it avoids any mention of the role played by Pakistani state actors, including the ISI. For instance, in the transcript that India had provided to it there was a reference to a "major general" who issued instructions to the attackers, but Islamabad has maintained silence on his identity.

The Pakistani response is not without its fallout in Islamabad. Intelligence inputs suggest that there is a growing rift between Pakistani President Asif Ali Zardari and Prime Minister Syed Yousuf Raza Gilani over the Mumbai investigations. While Gilani, under the influence of ISI and the army, wanted to soft-pedal the probe and delay it, Zardari has been pressing for a time-bound probe, partly under the US pressure and also because he realises that it was a similar cocktail of jihadi groups that killed his wife Benazir.

India realises that its diplomatic pressure has worked and that it has made Islamabad admit to its complicity, which has never happened in the past. So, in the coming days it will only mount more pressure. And the indications were there, during the week, when US special representative for Pakistan and Afghanistan Richard Holbrooke met External Affairs Minister Pranab Mukherjee. The message was also conveyed to Washington that while India had noted that Pakistan had taken the first step, the international community had to ensure that Islamabad followed it with action against the Mumbai attackers and dismantled the terror infrastructure. India will have to ensure that global heat is maintained on Pakistan so that the Mumbai investigations do not become just another tactical ploy by Islamabad to buy time and instead, some real and credible action is taken against the masterminds of 26/11. ■